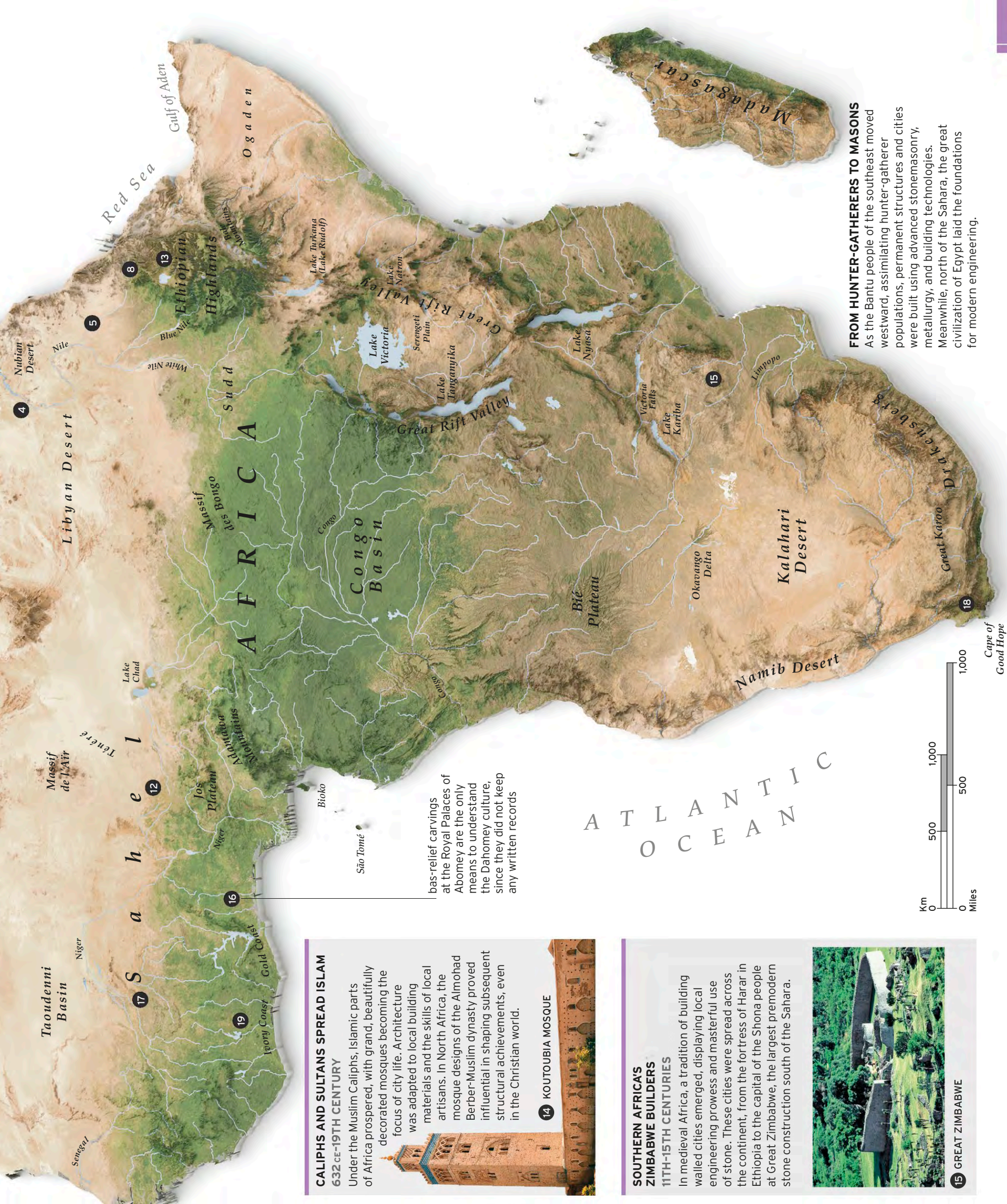




CALIPHS AND SULTANS SPREAD ISLAM
632 CE-19TH CENTURY

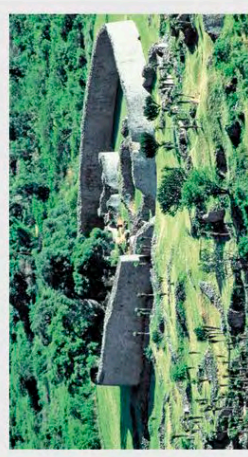
Under the Muslim Caliphs, Islamic parts of Africa prospered, with grand, beautifully decorated mosques becoming the focus of city life. Architecture was adapted to local building materials and the skills of local artisans. In North Africa, the mosque designs of the Almohad Berber-Muslim dynasty proved influential in shaping subsequent structural achievements, even in the Christian world.



14 KOUTOUBIA MOSQUE

SOUTHERN AFRICA'S ZIMBABWE BUILDERS
11TH-15TH CENTURIES

In medieval Africa, a tradition of building walled cities emerged, displaying local engineering prowess and masterful use of stone. These cities were spread across the continent, from the fortress of Harar in Ethiopia to the capital of the Shona people at Great Zimbabwe, the largest premodern stone construction south of the Sahara.



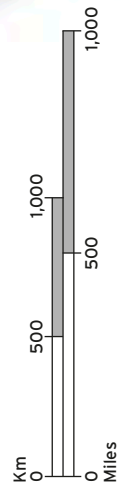
15 GREAT ZIMBABWE

FROM HUNTER-GATHERERS TO MASONRY

As the Bantu people of the southeast moved westward, assimilating hunter-gatherer populations, permanent structures and cities were built using advanced stonemasonry, metallurgy, and building technologies. Meanwhile, north of the Sahara, the great civilization of Egypt laid the foundations for modern engineering.

bas-relief carvings at the Royal Palaces of Abomey are the only means to understand the Dahomey culture, since they did not keep any written records

ATLANTIC OCEAN



Cape of Good Hope